

Silicon Valley Pledges \$200 Million to New Pro-A.I. Super PACs

The two PACs reflect a new level of political engagement by companies like Meta and investors such as Andreessen Horowitz, which are spending heavily on artificial intelligence.



Listen to this article · 4:13 min [Learn more](#)



By Theodore Schleifer and Eli Tan

Aug. 26, 2025

Silicon Valley corporations and investors, emboldened by President Trump's embrace of the technology and crypto industries, have pledged up to \$200 million to two new super PACs that are aimed at forcing out politicians whom they see as insufficiently supportive of the push into artificial intelligence.

One of the new PACs, Meta California, is funded by tens of millions of dollars from Meta, which owns Facebook and Instagram and has been investing heavily in A.I. The second super PAC, Leading the Future, is backed initially with \$50 million from the A.I. investor Andreessen Horowitz and \$50 million from Greg Brockman, a co-founder of OpenAI, and his wife, Anna.

The first-of-their-kind groups reflect a new appetite for political combat from the A.I. industry, which is a relatively new policy area without clear partisan allegiances.

Meta, Google, OpenAI, Microsoft and others are shoveling tens of billions of dollars into developing A.I. models, building data centers, hiring top researchers and taking a lead in the technology. At the same time, the companies face questions over whether A.I. might take away people's jobs and whether the technology is safe, as well as mounting concerns over the environmental effects of data centers.

The new super PACs are partly taking a page from the work of Fairshake, a group that was funded and run by some of the same investors and operatives to promote the crypto industry's interests. Fairshake backed pro-crypto congressional candidates, some of whom were elected last year, and was a major force in party primaries. This year, Congress passed a bill that was perceived to be friendly to the crypto industry.

Sign up to get Theodore Schleifer's articles emailed to you. Theodore Schleifer is a political reporter covering billionaires and their impact on the world. [Get it sent to your inbox.](#)

The up to \$200 million that is being committed is likely to immediately make the new groups, and the issue of A.I., somewhat central to the 2026 midterm elections. The groups promise to support both Democrats and Republicans.

While the sum of money is minor compared with the balance sheets of A.I. giants, the upside is potentially high, as the crypto industry can attest.

Meta has long had one of corporate America's largest lobbying operations, but the politically cautious tech giant has not previously pledged such a significant amount of money to a super PAC. The group will be run by Brian Rice and Greg Maurer, vice presidents of public policy at the company. Meta declined to give the precise amount it would donate, beyond its being "tens of millions" as an initial investment.

Meta has been lobbying on a prominent bill in California that would mandate that A.I. companies publicly disclose some safety protocols for their A.I. models, according to public filings. The bill passed the State Senate and is being read in the State Assembly.

At least 55 A.I.-related bills have been introduced by California lawmakers this year, the second most after New York. California is also home to OpenAI and the A.I. start-up Anthropic, as well incumbent tech giants like Meta, Google and Apple.

“Sacramento’s regulatory environment could stifle innovation, block A.I. progress and put California’s technology leadership at risk,” a Meta spokeswoman said in a statement. “This is why we are launching a California super PAC.”

Leading the Future similarly pledges to be involved in California. The group, which will technically be a collection of several political dark-money nonprofits and super PACs, just as Fairshake was, also plans to focus on New York, Illinois and Ohio, where policy fights on A.I. have already broken out.

The \$50 million from the Brockmans and the \$50 million from Andreessen Horowitz will come by the end of 2026. Other smaller initial backers of the effort include Perplexity, an A.I. company, and two Silicon Valley investors who have long been active in partisan politics, Joe Lonsdale and Ron Conway.

Theodore Schleifer is a Times reporter covering billionaires and their impact on the world.

Eli Tan covers the technology industry for The Times from San Francisco.

A version of this article appears in print on , Section B, Page 4 of the New York edition with the headline: Silicon Valley Puts Millions Into Political Help for A.I.